

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 39)

Page 192 - The Younger Poets

Q1. Did the close of the French Revolution mean the end of the revolutionary movement in European politics?

- A. Yes, all discontent completely ceased
- B. No, the people of Europe had been aroused and repeated disturbances occurred
- C. Yes, because a perfect democracy was established
- D. No, because the monarchy was permanently restored everywhere without opposition

Answer: B

Q2. Among the younger men, how did the fiery spirits react to the complacency of toryism?

- A. They wholeheartedly embraced it
- B. They found it impossible and were deeply affected by the failure of the democratic cause
- C. They moved to America to escape it
- D. They completely ignored politics

Answer: B

Q3. Which of the following moods did NOT typically result from the collapse of early revolutionary enthusiasm among the younger generation?

- A. Cynicism from exploded idealism
- B. Bitter disappointment and aimless unrest
- C. Joyful optimism and religious fervor
- D. Apathy and indifference

Answer: C

Q4. Who are named as the three chief poets of the younger revolutionary group?

- A. Wordsworth, Coleridge, and Southey
- B. Byron, Shelley, and Keats
- C. Scott, Campbell, and Moore
- D. Blake, Burns, and Cowper

Answer: B

Q5. How did the three chief younger poets differ from each other?

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- A. They lived in completely different eras
- B. They were politically opposed to one another
- C. They breathed the same atmosphere but showed striking contrasts in the quality and temper of their poetry
- D. They all wrote exclusively in blank verse

Answer: C

Q6. The later revolutionary age was generally characterized by a world that had emerged from long strain:

- A. Exhausted but satisfied
- B. Exhausted but not satisfied
- C. Energized and united
- D. Wealthy and powerful

Answer: B

Q7. The conditions of the later revolutionary age weighed heavily upon:

- A. The Augustan poets
- B. The Elizabethan dramatists
- C. The English poets born into that age
- D. The medieval minstrels

Answer: C

Q8. Which country did NOT experience repeated disturbances after the close of the French Revolution?

- A. Spain
- B. Portugal
- C. Italy
- D. The text says disturbances happened in Spain, Portugal, Italy, and Greece

Answer: D

Q9. What had set in among many of the older generation?

- A. A strong conservative reaction
- B. A massive religious revival
- C. A radical socialist movement
- D. A desire for absolute monarchy

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Answer: A

Q10. For a time, the principles of progress and popular government suffered:

- A. Rapid expansion
- B. Immediate realization
- C. Eclipse
- D. Global dominance

Answer: C

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Page 193 - Lord Byron

Q1. Who is described as the eldest and most thoroughly representative of the three younger poets?

- A. Percy Bysshe Shelley
- B. John Keats
- C. George Gordon, Lord Byron
- D. Thomas Moore

Answer: C

Q2. What spirit did Byron express more than any other English writer of his age?

- A. Quiet domesticity
- B. Religious devotion
- C. Rebellion (comprehensive, passionate, and impotent)
- D. Neoclassical rationality

Answer: C

Q3. What was the title of Byron's early volume of verse that was ferociously attacked by the Edinburgh Review?

- A. Hours of Idleness
- B. English Bards and Scotch Reviewers
- C. Lyrical Ballads
- D. Don Juan

Answer: A

Q4. How did Byron reply to the attack by the Edinburgh Review?

- A. With a humble apology
- B. By quitting poetry for five years
- C. With a vigorous satire called 'English Bards and Scotch Reviewers'
- D. By challenging the editor to a duel

Answer: C

Q5. Which poem's first two cantos scored an immense success in 1812?

- A. The Corsair

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- B. Childe Harold's Pilgrimage
- C. The Siege of Corinth
- D. Manfred

Answer: B

Q6. Who said, 'I woke up one morning and found myself famous'?

- A. Walter Scott
- B. Percy Bysshe Shelley
- C. Lord Byron
- D. John Keats

Answer: C

Q7. Which of the following is one of Byron's romances in verse?

- A. The Giaour
- B. Queen Mab
- C. Endymion
- D. The Lay of the Last Minstrel

Answer: A

Q8. Why did Byron leave England as an embittered man?

- A. He was banished by the King
- B. Scandal broke out after he and his wife separated
- C. He went bankrupt
- D. He wanted to join the French army

Answer: B

Q9. During his years of exile on the Continent, which great work did Byron produce?

- A. Childe Harold (cantos I and II)
- B. The Giaour
- C. Don Juan
- D. Hours of Idleness

Answer: C

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Q10. Where and how did Byron die?

- A. He was killed in battle in France
- B. He drowned in the Bay of Spezzia
- C. He died of a fever at Missolonghi in Greece
- D. He died of tuberculosis in Rome

Answer: C

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Page 194 - Byron's Poetry and Influence

Q1. Despite the apparent variety of Byron's voluminous work, why is the final impression one of monotony?

- A. He used the exact same meter for every poem
- B. He only wrote about the sea
- C. He was a supreme egotist and rarely travelled outside himself
- D. He copied all his plots from Shakespeare

Answer: C

Q2. As a critic and theorist, which school did Byron proclaim himself an adherent of?

- A. The Romantic school
- B. The Metaphysical school
- C. The Augustan school
- D. The Pre-Raphaelite brotherhood

Answer: C

Q3. Whom did Byron compare to a Greek temple?

- A. The poetry of the eighteenth century
- B. The poetry of his own time
- C. Wordsworth and Coleridge
- D. Shelley and Keats

Answer: A

Q4. What did Byron compare the poetry of his own time to?

- A. A Gothic cathedral
- B. A barbarous Turkish mosque
- C. A ruined castle
- D. A pristine Roman villa

Answer: B

Q5. What was the entire weight of Byron's practical influence on the side of?

- A. Classicism
- B. Romanticism

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- C. Realism
- D. Naturalism

Answer: B

Q6. Byron is at his best when he blends description with:

- A. Satire
- B. Action
- C. Meditation
- D. Dialogue

Answer: C

Q7. As a poet of nature, Byron glories in the sea because of:

- A. Its economic importance
- B. Its utter indifference to man
- C. Its calm and soothing waves
- D. Its religious symbolism

Answer: B

Q8. In which genre is Byron considered incomparably the greatest of modern English poets?

- A. The ode
- B. The pastoral elegy
- C. Satire (e.g., Vision of Judgment and Don Juan)
- D. Religious hymns

Answer: C

Q9. What does the term 'Byronism' denote?

- A. The spirit of joy, optimism, and peace
- B. The spirit of gloom, satiety, and unrest
- C. Strict adherence to classical rules
- D. The philosophical defense of monarchy

Answer: B

Q10. Which side of the revolutionary movement does Byron represent?

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- A. The constructive utopian side
- B. The socially organized side
- C. The destructive side only
- D. The purely political side

Answer: C

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Page 195 - Byron's Philosophy and Shelley's Early Life

Q1. What is the key-note of Byron's philosophy?

- A. God is love
- B. Vanity of vanities (blank negation)
- C. Progress is inevitable
- D. The rights of man

Answer: B

Q2. In what terms does Byron conceive liberty?

- A. In terms of social equality
- B. In terms of pure individualism
- C. In terms of constitutional law
- D. In terms of economic freedom

Answer: B

Q3. The heroes of Byron's romances (pirates, corsairs, outlaws) idealize all who are:

- A. In revolt against society
- B. Defenders of the crown
- C. Pious religious figures
- D. Wealthy merchants

Answer: A

Q4. Which poem is a terrific indictment of God's dealings with men as interpreted by current theology?

- A. Don Juan
- B. Childe Harold
- C. Cain
- D. Manfred

Answer: C

Q5. If Byron is the interpreter of revolutionary iconoclasm, what is Percy Bysshe Shelley?

- A. A strict conservative
- B. Our revolutionary idealist and prophet of faith and hope

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- C. A neoclassical satirist
- D. A purely descriptive nature poet

Answer: B

Q6. Why was Shelley expelled from Oxford?

- A. For fighting a duel
- B. For publishing a pamphlet on 'The Necessity of Atheism'
- C. For writing a satire on the King
- D. For refusing to attend classes

Answer: B

Q7. Who was Shelley's second wife?

- A. Harriet Westbrook
- B. Mary Godwin
- C. Dorothy Wordsworth
- D. Fanny Brawne

Answer: B

Q8. How did Shelley die in 1822?

- A. Of consumption in Rome
- B. In battle in Greece
- C. He drowned while sailing across the Bay of Spezzia
- D. By suicide in a London garret

Answer: C

Q9. Which of the following is Shelley's splendid elegy on the death of Keats?

- A. Lycidas
- B. In Memoriam
- C. Adonais
- D. Thyrsis

Answer: C

Q10. What is Shelley's 'The Cenci'?

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- A. A lyric ode
- B. A romantic drama of tragic intensity
- C. A political satire
- D. An epic poem in blank verse

Answer: B

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Page 196 - Shelley's Poetry

Q1. Shelley's genius was essentially:

- A. Dramatic
- B. Lyrical
- C. Satirical
- D. Didactic

Answer: B

Q2. Which of the following is one of Shelley's famous lyric poems?

- A. The Ancient Mariner
- B. Ode to the West Wind
- C. Childe Harold
- D. The Lay of the Last Minstrel

Answer: B

Q3. Shelley conceived it to be part of his poetic mission to become:

- A. The wealthiest writer in England
- B. A defender of the monarchy
- C. The inspirer and guide of men
- D. A translator of Latin epics

Answer: C

Q4. As explained in the preface to 'The Revolt of Islam', what did Shelley believe about the conservative reaction?

- A. That it was permanent and unconquerable
- B. That it was a temporary reaction and the dawn of a new day was at hand
- C. That it was justified and necessary
- D. That it had destroyed humanity forever

Answer: B

Q5. Which poem did Shelley write at eighteen, basing it on Godwin's 'Political Justice'?

- A. The Revolt of Islam

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- B. Adonais
- C. Queen Mab
- D. The Cenci

Answer: C

Q6. In 'Queen Mab', Shelley proclaims an individualistic philosophy that condemns:

- A. Kings, governments, church, property, and marriage
- B. Science and industry
- C. Democracy and equality
- D. Only the French revolutionaries

Answer: A

Q7. What redeeming quality does 'Queen Mab' possess despite its extravagant diatribe?

- A. Excellent comedic timing
- B. That fine passion for humanity which formed the basis of Shelley's religion
- C. Perfect heroic couplets
- D. Historical accuracy

Answer: B

Q8. In what verse form is 'The Revolt of Islam' written?

- A. Blank verse
- B. Heroic couplet
- C. Spenserian stanzas
- D. Terza rima

Answer: C

Q9. How does the hero of 'The Revolt of Islam', Laon, differ from Byron's heroes?

- A. Laon is a selfish pirate
- B. Laon is a self-engrossed egotist and mere rebel
- C. Laon is filled with unselfish enthusiasm and aims to be the saviour of society
- D. Laon is a wealthy aristocrat who hates the poor

Answer: C

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Q10. What is 'The Revolt of Islam' charged with?

- A. Support for the British Empire
- B. The young poet's hopes for the future regeneration of the world
- C. Cynical despair and blank negation
- D. A defense of orthodox Christianity

Answer: B